

CAST BIBLE: THE ENSEMBLE

STATUS:  **LOCKED.** Each person enters the story only when the showrunner says so.

In the story (as of Chapter One)	Still locked
Marc-Anthony Bullock (Tony Stark, cast Sept 2006) · Tayia Boyd (Pepper Potts, cast Jan 2007) · Amond Baker (Bruce Banner, announced Apr 12, 2007)	Tyrese Avery · Esther Smalley · Harmony Divine · Tyler Chapman · Elxa Bullock · Grace Bullock · Arianna Cummings · the Donohue–Bullock family

Canon rules for this cast

- All of the people listed here are **fictional African American actors** living in a real, diverse Hollywood. In 2007 Hollywood is still mostly white, especially in the executive suites.
- **Thor and Hawkeye are women, and always have been.** Thor is still the Odinson of Asgard and Hawkeye is still the world's greatest marksman. Hawkeye's name is **Claire Barton**. Nothing else about either character changes.
- "**Black don't crack.**" Everyone looks noticeably younger than their age. Each profile gives a "**Looks**" age next to the real one.
- Ages below are **as of Day One: Monday, March 12, 2007.**

CASTING RULES (LOCKED)

1. **The ten fictional-actor roles:** Tony Stark, Bruce Banner, Steve Rogers, Thor, Hank Pym, Janet van Dyne, Claire Barton, Natasha Romanoff, Wanda Maximoff and Pepper Potts are played by the fictional ensemble in this bible.
 2. **Every other Marvel character is played by the real-life actor who played them.** Samuel L. Jackson is Nick Fury (the one exception to the 616 rule on casting).
 3. **When more than one real actor played a role, the most iconic or longest-serving one gets it for the whole saga, and nobody is recast mid-saga.** Examples: **Don Cheadle** as James "Rhodey" Rhodes, **William Hurt** as Thunderbolt Ross, **Jon Favreau** as Happy Hogan, **Jeff Bridges** as Obadiah Stane.
 4. **Characters whose real-life portrayals came from films that don't exist in our reality** (Fox's X-Men and Fantastic Four, Sony's Spider-Man, and similar): **real actors play them, and the showrunner picks which actor when there was more than one.** They come in as each character enters the story.
 5. Even with real actors, **every character is still 100% Earth-616 and nobody is nerfed.** The actor is the only thing that comes from real life.
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FAME SCALE (2007)

Tier	Meaning
★★★★★ Global Icon	Recognized on sight in any country on Earth
★★★★ A-List	A household name in America, and a movie can open on their name
★★★ Known Face	"Hey, you're that guy/girl from...!"
★★ Working Actor	Respected in the industry, anonymous at the grocery store
★ Undiscovered	Still waiting for the call

THE DONOHUE–BULLOCK DYNASTY

VICTOR DONOHUE, the Patriarch

Born	May 30, 1936, Chicago, IL (South Side)
Age	70 · <i>Looks: mid-50s</i>
Titles	Founder & Chairman, Donohue Entertainment (1966–present); CEO (1966–1996)
Married	Joan Mercer, 1960
Net worth (2007)	≈ \$4.1 billion

A crooner out of the Chicago supper-club circuit, Victor had three gold records and a string of B-movie leading roles by 1962. Hollywood never gave him an A-picture, so in **1966, at age 30, he built his own company**. Donohue Entertainment started as a record label in a converted Crenshaw laundromat. It grew into film and TV production, a talent agency, and eventually one of the most important Black-owned entertainment companies in America. In this world, Donohue Entertainment is **what Motown would have become if it had also bought a movie studio**. Victor is warm, very shrewd, and he never forgets a slight. He still comes in to the office every Monday. He has one rule, and his grandchildren can recite it: "*Own the masters. Own the land. Own the name.*"

JOAN DONOHUE (née Mercer), the Matriarch

Born	April 17, 1938, New Orleans, LA
Age	68 (69 on Apr 17) · <i>Looks: early 50s</i>
Married	Victor Donohue, 1960

A New Orleans jazz singer turned screen actress, known for the 1960s melodramas that made audiences cry into their popcorn. In **1974 she became one of the first Black women to direct a feature for a major studio**, and she won an Emmy directing television in the 1980s. She's the family's conscience and its toughest critic. Her grandchildren are more afraid of Joan's silence than of Victor's temper.

NATASHA BULLOCK (née Donohue), the Mother & Manager

Born	June 2, 1961, Los Angeles, CA (<i>same birthday as Kevin Feige, which comes up later</i>)
Age	45 · Looks: <i>early 30s. People regularly mistake her for Elxa's older sister.</i>
Titles	CEO, Donohue Entertainment (1996–present); personal manager for all three of her children
Married	Robert Bullock, 1981

The only child of Victor and Joan. She was an 1980s R&B/pop star and film actress, with a Grammy, two Golden Globe nominations and a signature role as a jazz singer in *Blue Hour* (1987). She took over as CEO at **35** and turned Donohue into a modern media company. As a manager she is **feared in every agency in town**. She has walked her children out of three signed deals because the contracts had morality clauses written to target Black talent. She loves hard, negotiates harder, and has never lost her temper in public.

ROBERT BULLOCK, the Father & Director

Born	February 10, 1959, Oakland, CA (<i>same birthday as Amond Baker</i>)
Age	48 · Looks: <i>late 30s</i>
Married	Natasha Donohue, 1981

A UCLA film school graduate and a quiet perfectionist. He's an **Oscar-nominated director** (Best Director nomination, *Harbor Street*, 1994) of rich, humane family dramas. He shoots on real locations, uses long takes, and rehearses more than anyone else in town. He's the one who taught Marc-Anthony that the camera catches whatever you're thinking, even when you don't say it. He's calm, funny once you know him, and still hopelessly in love with his wife.

THE BULLOCK CHILDREN

MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK

MARVEL ROLE (LOCKED): Tony Stark / Iron Man

Born	January 5, 1982, Los Angeles, CA (Baldwin Hills)
Age	25 · Looks: 19–20
Birth order	Second child, oldest son of Natasha & Robert Bullock; grandson of Victor & Joan Donohue
Occupations	Actor · singer · screenwriter · filmmaker · producer
Fame (2007)	★★★★ A-List, but for the wrong things
Reported IQ	250
Future net worth	Over \$990 billion, and it goes up every single day (<i>future canon: locked</i>)

Who he is:

Marc-Anthony is the **sweetest, kindest, most loving, compassionate, innocent and pure-hearted man** in Hollywood. Crew members who have worked with him describe him the same way: *"He learns your kids' names."* He's also **the funniest person in any room**. His comedy is unhinged, unfiltered and gleefully offensive, and it spares nobody, including himself. The contrast is the key to him. His mouth has no brakes, and his heart has no bad bone in it.

He has natural presence on camera and in person. He's known for his natural appearance, distinctive features and effortless charisma, and paparazzi say he has never taken a bad photo.

The dream:

His number-one goal, ahead of Oscars, money or anything else, is **a family. A big, gigantic family**. Kids are non-negotiable. He believes in **generational wealth** the same way his grandfather does: build it, own it, pass it down. On every set he's on, the kids end up following him around, and it's been that way since he was one of the kids.

Career timeline:

| Year | Age | Credit |

|---|---|---|

| 1987 | 5 | First national commercial (a cereal ad). Meets Amond Baker at the audition. |

| 1991–1995 | 9–13 | **SPLAT!** (Nickelodeon), a kids' sketch-comedy show. Breakout cast member with Amond and Tayia. |

| 1994 | 12 | Tests at a **reported IQ of 250** during a *60 Minutes* segment on child prodigies, and the number follows him everywhere after that |

| 1995–1999 | 13–17 | **Brainiac** (Disney Channel), starring as Marcus Hayes, a 13-year-old genius who skips straight to college. The top show on the network. Two Kids' Choice Awards and a Daytime Emmy nomination. |

| 1996 | 14 | Finishes high school through on-set tutoring |

| 1997 | 15 | **Big Mouth** (family comedy, \$118M domestic) |

| 1998 | 16 | Puts his *Brainiac* earnings into Apple stock, buying at about \$13 a share while analysts were writing Apple off |

| 2000 | 18 | Debut album **Late Bloomer**: platinum, and a Grammy nomination for Best New Artist |

| 2000–2003 | 18–21 | **The Marc Bullock Show** (Nickelodeon), a teen variety show. He's head writer at 18. |

2003	21	**B.S. in Mechanical Engineering, USC**, *summa cum laude*, earned while filming full-time
2004	22	**Pledge Week**, an R-rated college comedy and a \$96M hit. Critics: "*Watching the Brainiac kid say that word is like watching your nephew smoke.*"
2004	22	Buys into the **Google IPO** (August 2004)
2005	23	Writes, directs and stars in ***The Long Way Home***, an indie drama about a father and son in Crenshaw. **Sundance Special Jury Prize**, and **Independent Spirit Award, Best First Screenplay**. It made \$4.2M at the box office, which is a flop by studio standards.
2006	24	HBO stand-up special ***Unsupervised***. Huge ratings, and a parents'-group boycott. He gives all his backend to Children's Hospital Los Angeles.
Sept 29, 2006	24	**Cast as Tony Stark in *Iron Man*** (Marvel Studios / Paramount). The industry reaction: "*Marvel bet \$140 million on the Brainiac kid.*"
Mar 12, 2007	25	*Iron Man* begins principal photography. He does his own stunts in the 90-lb practical Mark I.

The problem Iron Man ended (typecasting and a dry spell)

Before Marvel called, he went **14 months** without a greenlit project (July 2005 – September 2006). To the studios he's either "*the Brainiac kid*" or "*the Disney kid who curses now*," so every script his agency sends is a comedy. He has turned down **eleven** of them. *The Long Way Home* proved he can do drama, but almost nobody saw it. He was too famous to be treated as a newcomer and too typecast to be taken seriously. **Iron Man is his shot at proving he can grow up on screen, and half of Hollywood is waiting for him to fail.**

Relationships:

- **Amond Baker**: best friend since the cereal commercial in 1987. Brother. Right-hand man.
- **Grace Bullock**: his little sister and his ride-or-die.
- **Esther Smiley**: a close friend since childhood. 🔒 *Future canon: they get together in 2011 and marry in 2013. Not yet.*
- **Tayia Boyd**: co-star on *SPLAT!* and *Brainiac*. They have a great working relationship and read each other's timing without talking about it.

ELXA BULLOCK

MARVEL ROLE (LOCKED): Janet van Dyne / The Wasp

Born	August 29, 1980, Los Angeles, CA
Age	26 · Looks: 21
Birth order	First child, oldest daughter of Natasha & Robert Bullock
Occupations	Actress · television personality
Fame (2007)	★★★★ A-List as a <i>personality</i>

Backstory: Elxa was the child star of *The Mercers* (1986–1993), the family sitcom her grandmother Joan directed for Donohue Television, and she won a Young Artist Award at 9. As a teenager she did well in dramatic film roles, including a Golden Globe nomination for *Paper Wings* (1998) at 17. Then TV found her. Since 2002 she has hosted *Elxa After Dark*, the most talked-about late-night fashion and celebrity talk show on cable (**Daytime Emmy, Outstanding Talk Show Host, 2005**). She also runs a fashion label, **ELXA**, and New York Fashion Week treats her as royalty.

2007 problem: trouble getting back to mature work

She's so successful as a host that casting directors don't see her as an actress anymore. She hasn't had a film role since 2003. "*She's a personality*" is the most polite version of what gets said in casting meetings. She's the glamorous, funny, fearless one in the family, and she's quietly hungry to prove she's still an actor.

GRACE BULLOCK

MARVEL ROLE (LOCKED): Wanda Maximoff / The Scarlet Witch

Born	April 12, 1984, Los Angeles, CA
Age	22 (23 on Apr 12) · Looks: 17
Birth order	Youngest child and daughter of Natasha & Robert Bullock
Occupations	Actress · singer (musical theatre)
Fame (2007)	★★★ Known Face (★★★★★ on Broadway)

Backstory: Grace had her Broadway debut at 13 as Young Nala in *The Lion King* (1997). At **20** she won the **Tony Award for Best Actress in a Musical** for the revival of *Sweet Georgia Brown* (2004), which made her one of the youngest winners ever. She has a four-octave voice, is known on stage for **completely overwhelming emotional performances**, and is a hurricane offstage.

Her brother: Grace and Marc-Anthony are **ride-or-die**. In 2005 a paparazzo shoved Marc on Robertson Boulevard, and it took two bodyguards to hold Grace back. Everyone in the family knows she would **hide a body** for him without asking whose it was.

2007 problem: trouble translating to film

Her screen tests keep getting the same verdict: "*too big, too theatrical*." On stage she is a force of nature, but the camera needs her to pull back and she hasn't learned how. She's also 22 and looks 17, so she gets offered high-school roles.

THE ENSEMBLE

● AMOND BAKER

MARVEL ROLE (LOCKED): Bruce Banner / The Incredible Hulk

Born	February 10, 1982, Inglewood, CA
Age	25 · Looks: 19
Occupations	Actor · singer
Fame (2007)	★★★ Known Face (nostalgia fame)

Backstory: He met Marc-Anthony at the 1987 cereal-commercial audition when they were both 5, and they've been **inseparable since**. He was on *SPLAT!* (1991–1995) and played Marcus's roommate on *Brainiac*. His solo R&B album *Quiet Storm* (2003) was well reviewed but only sold about 180,000 copies. Tired of being the funny sidekick, he enrolled in **Juilliard's Drama Division at 20** and graduated in **2006**. He's a serious, disciplined, **deeply gifted dramatic actor**.

Personality: gentle, soft-spoken, anxious and thoughtful. He keeps his feelings under tight control, and when something finally breaks through, it's **frightening**. Directors who have seen it don't forget it. He's Marc's steady opposite: Marc is the explosion and Amond is the pressure underneath.

2007 problem: typecasting and a dry spell

His UPN sitcom *Baker's Dozen* was cancelled in 2006 when UPN merged into The CW. Hollywood still sees him as "*the funny best friend from SPLAT!*" Nobody has read his Juilliard reviews, and he has been out of work for nine months. **That ends on April 12, 2007, when Marvel announces him as Bruce Banner in *The Incredible Hulk***. Filming starts in Toronto that summer.

🔒 *Future canon: together with Harmony Divine in 2013, married 2015; daughter Lyric born April 20, 2014.*

● TYRESE AVERY

MARVEL ROLE (LOCKED): Steve Rogers / Captain America

Born	July 24, 1981, Fort Bragg, NC
Age	25 · Looks: 20
Occupations	Pop superstar · actor
Fame (2007)	★★★★★ Global Icon

Backstory: He's the son of **Sgt. First Class Harold Avery** (U.S. Army, 82nd Airborne) and a church choir director, and he grew up on bases from North Carolina to Germany. He was signed at 16 after a church-choir video circulated through the industry, and his debut single "**Stand Tall**" (1998) went to No. 1 in 23 countries. Since then: four albums, **more than 45 million records sold, five Grammys**, and sold-out stadium tours on four continents. He is clean-cut, sincere, polite to a fault, and a real believer in doing the right thing. His fan base, "the Averys," is the biggest in pop.

2007 problem: nobody takes his acting seriously

He has made two films. **Starlight** (2003) was a musical romance that critics tore apart ("*a two-hour music video*"). **Fast Lane** (2005) was an action movie that flopped with a \$38M domestic gross. The industry verdict is that he's "*a pop star in a costume.*" He's the most famous person in this cast and the one with the least credibility as an actor. Privately, it's what hurts him most.

● **ESTHER SMILLEY (later Bullock)**

MARVEL ROLE (LOCKED): Thor Odinson (*female; she has always been female*)

Born	September 20, 1982, Atlanta, GA
Age	24 · Looks: 16–17
Occupations	Actress · singer
Fame (2007)	★★★★ A-List as a <i>memory</i>

Backstory: She's "**the modern-day Shirley Temple.**" She was discovered at 3 singing at an Easter pageant in southwest Atlanta, and at 5 she starred in **Sunny** (1988), a tap-dancing musical that made \$140M and made her America's little sweetheart. After that came **Sunny Goes to Washington** (1990), **Sugar Hill Sweetheart** (1992), and a **Golden Globe nomination at age 9**, the youngest in the category's history. She met Marc-Anthony when they co-starred in the Disney holiday film **The Kid Who Stole Christmas** (1992), and they've been close friends ever since. She's known for natural beauty, distinctive features and effortless elegance. She's warm and gracious, has a dry wit, and **is far more competitive than anyone realizes.**

2007 problem: stuck as the child star

Every adult role she tries fails in the same way. **Magnolia Falls** (2003) was a Southern drama in which she played a widow; audiences laughed at her in the trailer. **Loose Change** (2005) was a romantic comedy, and critics wrote "*we can't see past the dimples.*" Her youthful looks make it worse: she's 24 and gets carded for R-rated movies. She's made a quiet living voicing animated films. **Nobody in Hollywood can picture her as a warrior god, and that is exactly why the role would work.**

🔒 *Future canon: together with Marc-Anthony in 2011, married 2013; twins Emma & Victoria born May 10, 2012.*

● HARMONY DIVINE (later Baker)

MARVEL ROLE (LOCKED): Natasha Romanoff / **Black Widow**

Born	June 19, 1982 (Juneteenth), Harlem, NY
Age	24 · Looks: 19
Occupations	Actress · dancer
Fame (2007)	★★★ Known Face (★★★★ on Broadway)

Backstory: She started at **Dance Theatre of Harlem** at 6, went to the School of American Ballet at 12, and attended a **Bolshoi summer intensive in Moscow at 17** (1999), where she picked up conversational Russian. She graduated from Juilliard with a BFA in Dance in 2004. On Broadway she played the lead in ***Harlem Nocturne*** (2005) and won the **Tony Award for Best Featured Actress in a Musical** plus the Astaire Award. Her first film, the dance movie ***Floor Work*** (2006), was a surprise \$61M hit.

Personality: precise, watchful and guarded. She notices everything and gives away very little, and she moves like no one else in any room she walks into.

2007 problem: typecasting

Since *Floor Work*, **every script she's offered is a dance movie**. She wants dramatic, dangerous parts with real depth, and Hollywood only wants her to dance. She has turned down four dance movies this year.

🔒 *Future canon: together with Amond Baker in 2013, married 2015.*

● TYLER CHAPMAN

MARVEL ROLE (LOCKED): Hank Pym / **Ant-Man**

Born	January 4, 1982, Washington, D.C.
Age	25 · Looks: 20
Occupations	Actor · musician
Fame (2007)	★★★ Known Face (TV)

Backstory: His father is a **biochemistry professor at Howard University** and his mother is an **entomologist at the Smithsonian**, so he grew up surrounded by ant farms. He plays cello, upright bass and keys, and fronts the D.C. neo-soul band **Tyler Chapman & The Colony**, which has a loyal following and one Grammy nomination. He's best known as **Dr. Wendell Pryce**, the lab tech everyone loved on CBS's ***Crime Lab: Baltimore*** (2002–2006).

Personality: brilliant, restless and prone to second-guessing himself. He's a perfectionist with a huge heart and a habit of talking himself out of good things.

2007 problem: typecasting and a dry spell

Crime Lab: Baltimore was cancelled in May 2006. Since then he's had four offers, and **all four were lab techs**. Hollywood has decided he's "*the science guy*," and he hasn't had an acting job in ten months.

 ARIANNA CUMMINGS

MARVEL ROLE (LOCKED): Claire Barton / Hawkeye (*female; she has always been female*)

Born	October 25, 1982, Waverly, Iowa (<i>the same town as Hawkeye in the comics; nobody at Marvel knows yet</i>)
Age	24 · Looks: 19
Occupations	Actress
Fame (2007)	★ Undiscovered

Backstory: Her father is a diesel mechanic and her mother teaches middle-school English, and they were one of a handful of Black families in a small Iowa town. She was a **Junior Olympic Archery Development (JOAD) national champion at 15** and a gymnast, and she's never missed a free throw that mattered. She moved to Los Angeles at 18 in 2001 with \$900 and a Greyhound ticket. Since then she's had **more than 40 guest spots** (usually "Victim of the Week" on procedurals), a regional phone commercial, and a lot of stand-in and stunt-double work. She works mornings at a coffee shop in Silver Lake.

Personality: a sarcastic smart-mouth who is fiercely loyal, never gives up, and never misses.

2007 problem: no breakthrough yet

She's spent six years hearing "*not the type*," and for every possible type: too athletic, too country, too urban, not urban enough. She's the only person in this cast who has never had a real chance. She is also the one who has been **training for this role her whole life without knowing it**.

 TAYIA BOYD

MARVEL ROLE (LOCKED): Virginia "**Pepper**" Potts (*Earth-616: Tony's executive assistant, later CEO of Stark Industries, and eventually the armored hero Rescue, with no nerfs*)

Born	February 3, 1982, Chicago, IL (Chatham)
Age	25 · Looks: 19
Occupations	Actress
Fame (2007)	★★★ Known Face (nostalgia fame)

Backstory: She was on ***SPLAT!*** (1991–1995) with Marc and Amond, then played **Keisha Grant**, Marcus Hayes's best friend and rival, on ***Brainiac*** (1995–1999). She and Marc-Anthony have **excellent professional chemistry**. Their comic timing is so closely matched that *Brainiac* writers used to leave gaps in the script and let the two of them fill them. She's co-starred with him in three Disney Channel Original Movies and a Nickelodeon special.

2007 problem: typecasting

She's the lead's funny best friend on a mid-rated network sitcom (***Two Doors Down***, NBC, 2005–present). Casting sees her as "*the sassy best friend*," which is the part she's been playing since she was nine. She's ready to be the lead. **In January 2007 she's cast as Pepper Potts** and shoots *Iron Man* during her sitcom's hiatus.

Why she's Pepper: Tony and Pepper's back-and-forth is the most important relationship in Iron Man's corner of the universe, and Tayia and Marc-Anthony have been doing that rhythm on screen since they were nine. With them it's instinct, not acting.



SEALED FUTURE CANON (do not use until unlocked)

Date	Event
2011	Marc-Anthony Bullock & Esther Smilley become a couple (after years of friendship)
May 10, 2012	Emma Bullock born (older twin by 25 minutes). A 1000% daddy's girl and Marc's double: she inherited his talent and personality. Spoiled endlessly, but respectful, responsible, and she knows the meaning of hard work.
May 10, 2012	Victoria Bullock born (younger twin). Also a 1000% daddy's girl who inherited his talent and personality, and a wild child, just about kept in check. Respectful, responsible, and she knows the meaning of hard work.
2013	Marc-Anthony & Esther marry. Amond Baker & Harmony Divine become a couple.
April 20, 2014	Lyric Baker born to Amond & Harmony. Marc-Anthony is her godfather. A literal sweetheart and angel.
2015	Amond & Harmony marry
Ongoing	Marc-Anthony's personal net worth passes \$990 billion and keeps rising every day

AGE QUICK-REFERENCE (as of Monday, March 12, 2007)

Name	Born	Age	Looks
Victor Donohue	May 30, 1936	70	mid-50s
Joan Donohue	Apr 17, 1938	68	early 50s
Robert Bullock	Feb 10, 1959	48	late 30s
Natasha Bullock	Jun 2, 1961	45	early 30s
Elxa Bullock	Aug 29, 1980	26	21
Tyrese Avery	Jul 24, 1981	25	20
Tyler Chapman	Jan 4, 1982	25	20
Marc-Anthony Bullock	Jan 5, 1982	25	19–20
Tayia Boyd	Feb 3, 1982	25	19
Amond Baker	Feb 10, 1982	25	19
Harmony Divine	Jun 19, 1982	24	19
Esther Smilley	Sep 20, 1982	24	16–17
Arianna Cummings	Oct 25, 1982	24	19
Grace Bullock	Apr 12, 1984	22	17